Goals of the EU

Protecting freedom and human rights

- The right to freedom from discrimination and the protection of minorities
- Human rights are universal
- The right of freedom
- Freedom of speech, freedom of religion, freedom of artistic expression, and freedom of occupation

Strengthening democracy

- EU citizens have the right to freely express their opinions, elect their political representatives, and have a say in decisions about their future.
- Package to Defend Democracy:
  - → Protecting democratic life in the EU
  - → Recommendation to promote the participation of citizens and civil society organizations in political decision-making processes

Living in solidarity

- Promotes economic, social, and territorial cohesion among the member states
- Examples from our 4 countries:
- *Lettland* provided shelter to 43,000 people from Ukraine
- Following floods in the Carpathian Foothills, *Poland* received EU reconstruction funds

Living in solidarity

- ***Italy*** **contributes to EU structural funds that benefit poorer regions in Eastern Europe.**
- ***Germany*** **is the largest donor country. It has contributed more money than it has received in return.**

Climate Protection and Sustainable Action

- Satisfy present needs without compromising future generations
- Greenhouse gas neutrality by 2050
- Achieve sustainable development
- Preserve and protect the environment
- Strengthen support for organic farming
- Development of renewable energy

Promoting peace and security

- Nobel Peace Prize 2012:

  → Recognition for peace and reconciliation, democracy and human rights

- "The EU is a peace project"

Improvement of living conditions, reduction of inequalities, and strengthening of workers' rights

Promote the economy and the single market

- Free movement of goods, people, services, and capital within the EU
- Promoting a competitive, stable, and innovative economy through common rules andsupport programs
- Improvement of living conditions, reduction of inequalities, and strengthening of workers’ rights